



KNOW HOW



Q I have installed a Linux machine without GUI. Please let me know how can I set the time on the command prompt? I can only log in to it by using SSH.

—Kumar Srinivas, by email

A. You can use the `date` command to set the time if you are not using NTP or you are not connected to the Internet. You can set `date` and `time` manually using the following command from the shell prompt as root:

```
date -s "22 JAN 2009 20:10:00"
```

or:

```
date +%Y%m%d -s "20090122"
```

Or, to just set the time, you can use:

```
date +%T -s "20:13:10"
```

...where 20 is hours, 13 is minutes and 10 is seconds. You can use `%p` if you want to set time in AM or PM format.

Q I have Fedora Core 6 installed on my machine. I was running out of space due to the low capacity of the hard disk drive. I have bought a new hard drive of 160 GB, but am unable to understand how to install and format it. I have physically connected the HDD as primary slave and the same is also detected by my system BIOS. How do I format

and use this hard disk?

—Priyanka Trivedi, by email

Since your new hardware is recognised by the BIOS, you need to check through your OS the device name that has been assigned to it. Run the following command as root to know the details:

```
# ls /dev/hd*
```

or:

```
# fdisk -l
```

This will give you the device name that your new hard disk has been assigned (in your case it should be `hdb`).

After you know the device name you need to divide the hard disk into partitions. To do this you can use the `fdisk` command as follows:

```
# fdisk /dev/hdb
```

Command (m for help):

You can press `m` to get the list of options. Press `p` to get the listing of the partitions—in your case this should display no partition, as it's a new disk.

So, let's create a new partition by pressing `n`, and follow the on-screen display:

```
command (m for help): n
```

```
command action
```

```
e extended
```

```
p primary partition (1-4)
```

As you can see from the terminal output, you can choose `p` to make a primary partition. `fdisk` always sets partition to 83 (Linux type) by default, although you always have options to play with different types of filesystems. Once you are done with partitioning, just press `w` to

write the modifications permanently.

Next, format the partition you have just created. To format the new disk you can use the `mkfs` tool. This tool is used to build a Linux filesystem on a device—usually a hard disk partition (assuming that you have created only one partition):

```
# mkfs -t ext3 /dev/hdb1
```

This will format your hard disk as an `ext3` filesystem. Once `mkfs` has finished its work, your partition is ready to be mounted and used. To mount the new partition, just create a folder in the `/media` directory named `hdb1` or anything you wish, and run the following command:

```
# mount -t ext3 /dev/hdb1 /media/hdb1
```

This will mount your partition. However, the next time you reboot your system, you have to manually mount it again. To mount your partition automatically every time you boot your system, you need to append the following line in the `/etc/fstab` file:

```
/dev/hdb1 /mnt/hdb1 ext3 default 2 1
```

Q I have an old Linux with Openoffice 2.0 installed on my laptop. I have few true-type fonts that I used with Windows. Is there any way by which I can use these fonts in my OpenOffice.org too?

—Sebastian John, by email

I'm assuming you want to use these fonts in your Fedora system. In that case, simply copy the fonts in your `/usr/share/fonts/` directory—remember, you need root privileges for this action. You should now be able to use these fonts in OpenOffice.org and other assorted Linux applications. **END** 